



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Texas



U.S. Attorney Damien M. Diggs Announces Departure

Friday, January 10, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of Texas

PLANO, Texas – United States Attorney [Damien M. Diggs](#) has announced that he will resign as the chief federal law enforcement officer for the Eastern District of Texas effective 11:59 p.m. on January 21, 2025. U.S. Attorney Diggs was nominated by President Joseph R. Biden on February 2, 2023, and unanimously confirmed by the U.S. Senate on May 4, 2023. Mr. Diggs was sworn in as U.S. Attorney on May 7, 2023.

"I will forever be grateful to President Biden, Attorney General Garland, and Senators John Cornyn and Ted Cruz for having confidence in me to serve our nation and the citizens of the Eastern District of Texas," said U.S. Attorney Diggs. "This office and our committed local, state, and federal law enforcement partners go above and beyond daily to keep our communities safe, uphold the rule of law, and protect the civil rights of the citizenry. I count it a blessing to have assisted in these efforts."

In a message to his office and law enforcement partners, U. S. Attorney Diggs said:

It has been an honor and a privilege leading this District for the past two years. I can proudly say that the Eastern District, the state of Texas, and the United States are safer because of the great work being done here. During my tenure as United States Attorney, the work of this Office has reached five continents in the pursuit of justice and has remained a leader in the fight against international criminal organizations, while simultaneously remaining an active and engaged partner in our communities in north- and southeastern Texas.

U.S. Attorney Diggs led an office of nearly 100 employees, including 50 prosecutors, across six fully staffed offices in Beaumont, Lufkin, Plano, Sherman, Texarkana, and Tyler. The district covers 43 counties stretching from the Gulf of Mexico to the Oklahoma border, covering 29,000 square miles, and is home to roughly 4.5 million people. He focused the office's efforts on public safety, fighting fraud, waste and abuse, civil rights, and community outreach.

Under U.S. Attorney Diggs' leadership, the office achieved noteworthy successes in criminal matters, obtaining notable victories in crimes related to [gun](#) and [gang](#) violence, [firearms trafficking](#), [drug trafficking](#), [public corruption](#), [healthcare fraud](#), [white collar](#), [cybercrime](#), [national security issues](#), [child exploitation](#), and [human trafficking](#) issues. U.S. Attorney Diggs also expanded the office's Project Safe Neighborhoods program by creating separate PSN programs in Beaumont, Longview, and Plano; established [Operation Purple Ribbon](#)—a domestic violence initiative targeting [domestic violence abusers](#) for federal prosecution; surged investigations and prosecutions of commercial robberies; stood up a carjacking task force in the spring of 2024, which has resulted in a significant decrease in carjackings district-wide; and partnered with the other Texas U.S. Attorneys and the ATF in the summer of 2024 in launching [Operation Texas Kill Switch](#)—a statewide initiative targeting illegal machinegun conversion devices, commonly referred to as "switches." The initiative has raised public awareness and resulted in [multiple prosecutions](#).

U.S. Attorney Diggs continued the district's prioritization of prosecuting large-scale drug trafficking organizations, primarily through DOJ's Organized Crime Drug Enforcement Task Force (OCDETF) program. With an emphasis on the targeting of international drug cartels, U.S. Attorney Diggs oversaw one of the nation's most productive extradition practices, particularly with respect to Colombia and Guatemala. U.S. Attorney Diggs' team obtained a 25-year sentence against a [Colombian trafficker](#) who coordinated maritime shipments of cocaine through Central America; extradited the leader of the [Los Pochos](#) drug trafficking organization which supplies multi-ton quantities of cocaine to trafficking cells in Guatemala and Mexico; and successfully prosecuted a former senior [Republic of Guatemala official](#) whose assistance on behalf of an international drug trafficker resulted in the safe passage of at least 450 kilograms of cocaine through Guatemala for distribution in the United States.

The office's Civil Division experienced record successes under U.S. Attorney Diggs' leadership. For instance, the Civil Division negotiated a [\\$97 million settlement](#) with Walgreens to resolve allegations that it billed government payors for prescriptions that were never dispensed. U.S. Attorney Diggs also oversaw a [\\$21.75 million settlement](#) with Medisca, Inc. to resolve allegations that the company submitted false and inflated average wholesale prices for ingredients used in compounded prescriptions. U.S. Attorney Diggs also demonstrated a commitment to holding individuals, not just corporations, responsible for defrauding the government. After obtaining a settlement with the bankrupt fintech company Kabbage, Inc. to receive a total unsubordinated general unsecured claim in the bankruptcy proceeding of up to [\\$120 million](#), U.S. Attorney Diggs approved the United States' [intervention against three former executives of Kabbage, Inc.](#) Under his leadership, the Civil Division also obtained a settlement with the CEO of a Texas hospital, who paid [\\$5.3 million to resolve allegations](#) under the False Claims Act involving illegal payments to physicians for laboratory referrals in violation of the Anti-Kickback Statute.

U.S. Attorney Diggs dedicated himself to protecting the civil rights of citizens of the Eastern District of Texas. He oversaw the district's partnership with the other Texas U.S. Attorney's Offices and the Justice Department's Civil Rights Division to investigate allegations of civil rights violations at Texas Juvenile Justice Department ("TJJD") facilities across the state. The [investigation found](#) that TJJD violated the rights of children housed in those facilities.

The Appellate Division also had notable victories under U.S. Attorney Diggs' leadership. For instance, the Appellate Division persuaded the Fifth Circuit to affirm the 90-month sentence of a [Colombian lawyer](#) who falsely told drug traffickers that, for a fee, she could prevent their extradition to the United States; successfully defended the federal-programs bribery convictions of a [local politician and her spouse](#)—a real estate developer; and urged the Fifth Circuit to uphold the convictions of [Aryan Circle prison gang members](#) who were convicted of RICO conspiracy for their participation in various acts of violence and drug distribution.

As U.S. Attorney, Mr. Diggs has prioritized his office's engagement in the community, particularly when it comes to fentanyl awareness presentations where prosecutors across the district have given [One Pill Can Kill](#) presentations to students across the district. U.S. Attorney Diggs, along with the other Texas U.S. Attorneys, met with state education leaders in Austin to provide fentanyl-related information and awareness that could be used in schools state-wide. Additionally, in partnership with the Justice Department's Community Relations Service, U.S. Attorney Diggs has spearheaded civil rights and hate crimes prevention through [United Against Hate](#) presentations across the district designed to raise community awareness about hate crimes, hate incidents and discrimination, and establishes connections between law enforcement and ethnic communities and religious groups, particularly those with members who have been reluctant to contact law enforcement for help.

Beyond leading in the Eastern District of Texas, U.S. Attorney Diggs was a member of the Attorney General Advisory Subcommittees on Violent Crime, White Collar/Fraud, Cybercrime/Intellectual Property, and Terrorism/National Security. He also served a member of a Working Group dealing with FIRREA whistleblower issues.

Pursuant to the Vacancies Reform Act, First Assistant U.S. Attorney Abe McGlothlin Jr. will succeed Mr. Diggs as the Acting U.S. Attorney for the Eastern District of Texas until a successor is nominated by the President and confirmed by the United States Senate.

Learn more about the district at: <https://www.justice.gov/usao-edtx>.

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PRESS RELEASE

Eastern District of Texas honors Jacksonville Police Officer with Hometown Hero Award

U.S. Attorney Jay R. Combs of the Eastern District of Texas announced Officer Elyse Hand of the Jacksonville Police Department as the district's 2026 Hometown Hero Award recipient.

May 22, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Eastern District of Texas observes National Crime Victims' Rights Week

Eastern District of Texas U.S. Attorney Jay R. Combs joins the Department of Justice's Office for Victims of Crime (OVC) and the Executive Office for the United States Attorneys (EOUSA)...

April 21, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Richardson man sentenced to federal prison for mail theft

A Richardson man has been sentenced to prison for federal violations in the Eastern District of Texas, announced U.S. Attorney Jay R. Combs.

December 15, 2025



Eastern District of Texas

Beaumont Office:

